

Homework 1C “How to Read a Research Paper”.

Next week's topic will be “How to Read a Research Paper”. Attached is a document to help you prepare.

Complete all of the tasks and submit the deliverables in class on **Thursday, September 10th**.

Task 1.

- Download the reading materials
 - Keshav, S. (2007). How to read a paper. ACM SIGCOMM Computer Communication Review, 37(3), 83–84.
- Print the paper and annotate it **by hand** while reading.
 - Your annotations should clearly mark where you find the answers to the questions in the Guided Reading Quiz.

Task 2.

- Print and complete the Guided Reading Quiz **by hand** (attached)
 - Answer the questions based on the reading materials

Deliverables:

1. A completed quiz document - Guided Reading Quiz
2. A printed and hand-annotated copy of the Keshav (2007) paper. The annotations (highlights, underlines, margin notes) must clearly show where the answers to the Guided Reading Quiz questions were found in the text.

Guided Reading Quiz

Student name: _____

Student ID: _____

Part 1 — Multiple Choice Questions (MCQ)

Q1 What problem does the paper primarily address?

- A. How to write a research paper
- B. How researchers should evaluate conference submissions
- C. How to efficiently read and understand research papers
- D. How to design experiments

Q2 According to the paper, why is reading research papers often inefficient for beginners?

- A. Papers are written in multiple languages
- B. The skill of reading papers is rarely formally taught
- C. Papers are too short to contain useful information
- D. Most papers do not contain experiments

Q3 The core method proposed in the paper is:

- A. The iterative reading method
- B. The hierarchical reading method
- C. The three-pass method
- D. The recursive reading method

Q4 Which of the following is **NOT** part of the first pass?

- A. Reading the abstract
- B. Carefully studying the experiments
- C. Looking at section headings
- D. Glancing at figures and references

Q5 The goal of the **first pass** is to:

- A. Reproduce the experiments
- B. Understand the full methodology
- C. Get a general idea of the paper
- D. Write a literature review

Q6 Approximately how long should the **first pass** take?

- A. 1–2 minutes
- B. 5–10 minutes
- C. 20–30 minutes
- D. 1–2 hours

Q7 During the **second pass**, the reader should:

- A. Ignore figures and tables
- B. Examine figures and results carefully
- C. Rewrite the entire paper
- D. Skip the introduction

Q8 What should a reader **NOT attempt** during the second pass?

- A. Understanding the structure of the argument
- B. Evaluating whether results make sense
- C. Reproducing the paper in detail
- D. Reading figures carefully

Q9 What is the main goal of the **third pass**?

- A. Memorize the references
- B. Reconstruct the paper and fully understand it
- C. Only read the conclusion
- D. Identify the authors

Q10 The three-pass method is especially useful for:

- A. Writing programming code
- B. Conducting literature surveys
- C. Formatting papers for submission
- D. Designing hardware systems

Part 2 — Short Answer Questions

Q1 What is the main motivation for proposing the three-pass method?	
Q2 List the three passes described in the paper.	
Q3 During the first pass , what types of information should the reader focus on?	
Q4 What are the five key questions the reader should be able to answer after the first pass?	
Q5 Why are figures and graphs especially important during the second pass?	

Q6 What is the main difference between the second pass and the third pass?	
Q7 During the third pass, what does the author suggest the reader should try to reconstruct?	
Q8 How can the three-pass method help when performing a literature survey?	
Q9 Why is it useful to scan the references during early reading passes?	
Q10 According to the paper, what should a reader do if they cannot understand the paper after the second pass?	